PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Dynamic Pricing & Max-Price Bidding

Marketing Messages API for WhatsApp

Status	Draft – Beta Integration
Version	1.1
Last Updated	April 2026
Phase	Limited Beta (mid-May 2026)
Audience	BSP / Direct Integrators / Partner-Enabled Businesses
Feature	max-price bid_spec + Reach Estimation API

Version History

Version	Changes
1.0	Initial Draft
1.1	Added user stories for reports (U8) and billing (U9); updated U3 per-message multiplier to slider control (min 1.0×, max 3.0×, step 0.1); updated U4 reach estimation to show values only after messaging events triggered

1. Executive Summary

Meta is introducing a voluntary max-price bidding feature on the Marketing Messages (MM) API for WhatsApp in 2026. This document specifies the requirements for implementing this feature on our platform, enabling businesses to control the maximum price they are willing to pay per message delivery and to preview expected reach and cost before committing spend.

This feature exits the Extended Alpha phase and enters Limited Beta in mid-May 2026, with Open Beta planned for October 2026 and General Availability (GA) in Q2 2027.

> **Why this matters**
>
> Today, every marketing message costs the same regardless of audience value or urgency.
>
> Dynamic pricing moves WhatsApp from a commodity channel to a performance marketing channel.
>
> Businesses that adopt bidding can lower cost per acquisition, expand reach, and increase delivery on priority campaigns — all within the same platform.

2. Problem Statement

Current state: Marketing messages on the WhatsApp Business Platform are priced at a fixed, published rate. Every message costs the same regardless of audience value, campaign urgency, or expected ROI.

2.1 Core Pain Points

- Flat pricing penalises high-value sends. A message to a VIP customer costs the same as one to a cold prospect.
- No lever for urgency. During peak campaigns (sales events, holidays), businesses cannot prioritise delivery.
- Spending is inefficient. Businesses over-spend on low-return audiences and under-invest in high-return segments.
- Messaging is static, not performance-driven. Unlike ad platforms, messaging has no mechanism to bid on delivery probability.

2.2 Business Impact

- Revenue per message is capped at published rates with no upside for the platform.

- Businesses that could benefit from WhatsApp stay on cheaper but less-engaged channels.
- Platform competitiveness erodes against ad-based channels (Meta Ads, email, SMS) that offer bidding.

3. Goals & Success Metrics

3.1 Product Goals

1. Enable max-price bidding at the template level and optionally at the per-message level.
2. Surface reach estimation so businesses can set informed bids before sending.
3. Zero regression for businesses not opting into dynamic pricing.
4. Seamless enablement flow for BSPs and Direct Integrators during beta.

3.2 Success Metrics

Metric	Target (Beta)	Target (GA)
Bidding adoption rate (WABAs)	≥ 20% of enabled WABAs	≥ 60% of eligible WABAs
Avg. cost vs published rate (same bid)	≤ published rate	≤ published rate
Reach Estimation API usage	≥ 50% of bidding sessions	≥ 70% of bidding sessions
Regression: non-bidding workflows	0 regressions	0 regressions
API error rate (131061, 100)	< 0.5%	< 0.1%

4. Scope

4.1 In Scope

- Template-level bid (bid_spec) creation, retrieval, and update via Template API
- Per-message bid multiplier (per_message_bid_multiplier) via Message Sending API
- Reach Estimation API integration and display

- Feature gating by WABA / Business ID (Meta-enabled accounts only)
- UI surfaces: Template creation form, campaign send flow, estimation widget
- Error handling for codes 131061 and 100
- Reporting: two new columns in WhatsApp template reports (Billing Type, Actual Cost per Message)
- Billing module: logic for standard and custom pricing cases

4.2 Out of Scope

- Automated or AI-driven bid optimisation (future roadmap)
- Segment-level or per-user audience pricing
- Integration with non-WhatsApp channels
- Changes to Webhooks, Metrics, or Billing SKU (MARKETING_LITE)
- Cloud API (/messages endpoint): bidding requires /marketing_messages only

4.3 Constraints

- Marketing templates only. Non-marketing categories do not support bid_spec.
- Meta enablement required. Feature is not self-serve as WABAs must be whitelisted by Meta.
- Correct API endpoint. Templates with bid_spec must be sent via /marketing_messages, not /messages.
- Estimation is probabilistic. Reach estimates are based on historical data and are not guaranteed.
- Geo restrictions apply. Feature not available in certain countries per Meta policy.

5. Feature Enablement & Rollout

5.1 Rollout Phases

Phase	Timeline	Scope	Partner Action
Extended Alpha	Now (Apr 2026)	Per WABA (2–5 WABAs per BSP)	Share test WABA IDs with Meta
Limited Beta	Mid-May 2026	Per Business (2–5 Business IDs)	Sign beta agreement; share Business IDs
Open Beta	Oct 2026	All clients for any partner	Enable for full client base

GA	Q2 2027 (planned)	Default in eligible geographies	Max-price becomes default mechanism

5.2 Activation Flow

5. BSP / Direct Integrator signs max-price beta agreement with Meta.
6. Share 2–5 WhatsApp Business Account IDs (or Business IDs for Limited Beta) with Meta for enablement.
7. Meta enables the feature on the specified accounts.
8. BSP validates via API that bid_spec is accepted on enabled WABAs.
9. Feature is surfaced in the product UI for enabled accounts only.

Integration timeline

Meta recommends 6–8 calendar weeks for full integration of max-price and reach estimation APIs.

Plan accordingly before the Limited Beta launch in mid-May 2026.

6. Functional Requirements

6.1 Feature Gating (WABA Level)

User Story U1: *As a platform operator, I want bidding to be available only to Meta-enabled WABAs, so that unenabled accounts are not affected.*

Acceptance Criteria

- AC1: Maintain a meta_enabled flag per WABA, synced from Meta's enablement API or manually seeded during onboarding.
- AC2: If flag = FALSE: hide all bidding UI elements; do not include bid_spec in any outbound API calls.
- AC3: If flag = TRUE: display bidding UI and allow full bid_spec flow.
- AC4: Existing template creation and message sending workflows remain 100% unchanged for non-enabled WABAs.
- AC5: Feature flag changes take effect within 5 minutes without requiring user re-login.

Definition of Done

- meta_enabled flag is stored per WABA and correctly reflects Meta's enablement status
- Flag can be seeded manually during onboarding and updated without requiring a deployment
- Flag state change propagates to the UI within 5 minutes without user re-login
- Bidding UI elements (toggle, bid input, estimation widget) are completely hidden for non-enabled WABAs — verified across template creation and campaign send screens
- bid_spec is confirmed absent from all outbound API calls for non-enabled WABAs via integration tests
- Existing template creation and message sending flows for non-enabled WABAs pass full regression test suite with zero failures
- QA has tested flag toggling in both directions (enabled → disabled, disabled → enabled) and confirmed correct UI and API behaviour in each state

6.2 Template-Level Bidding

User Story U2: *As a business user, I want to optionally set a maximum bid price when creating a marketing template, so I can control the delivery cost ceiling for that template.*

UI Behaviour

- Toggle: "Enable Max-Price Bidding" (default OFF). Only visible for marketing category templates.
- Input field: Cost per message (primary display). Show equivalent cost per 1,000 messages as secondary label.
- Currency: Display in the WABA's WhatsApp Business Account currency.

Backend Conversion

```
bid_amount = round(per_message_price × 1000 × currency_factor
```

This integer is sent as bid_amount in bid_spec, alongside bid_strategy: LOWEST_COST_WITH_BID_CAP.

Acceptance Criteria

- AC1: Toggle OFF → bid_spec is excluded from the Template API call; standard rate card applies.
- AC2: Toggle ON → bid_spec is included with bid_amount and bid_strategy.
- AC3: bid_amount must be a positive integer greater than zero.
- AC4: UI shows cost per message as primary and cost per 1,000 as secondary.
- AC5: Once a max-price is set on a template, it cannot be removed. Display a persistent notice: "To use published rates, create a new template without a max-price."

- AC6: Editing constraints enforced: for approved templates, max 1 edit per 24 hours or 10 edits per 30 days (whichever is stricter); rejected/paused templates have unlimited edits.

Validations

- V1: Reject zero or negative values with inline error.
- V2: Apply configurable maximum bid limit (advised by business operations).
- V3: Limit decimal precision to ≤ 4 decimal places before conversion.
- V4: Prevent bidding on non-marketing template categories (server-side and client-side guard.

Definition of Done

- Bidding toggle is visible only on marketing category templates and hidden for all other categories (UTILITY, AUTHENTICATION, SERVICE) — verified on both frontend and backend
- Toggle OFF state confirmed to exclude bid_spec from Template API payload; standard rate card pricing applies
- Toggle ON state confirmed to include bid_spec with correct bid_amount (integer) and bid_strategy: LOWEST_COST_WITH_BID_CAP
- Backend conversion formula has been unit tested across at least 3 currencies with edge case values (min, max, 4-decimal precision)
- UI displays cost per message as primary and cost per 1,000 as secondary — values are consistent with the converted bid_amount at all times
- Persistent notice ("To use published rates, create a new template without a max-price") is displayed once a bid is set and survives page refresh
- Editing constraints enforced and tested: approved templates reject a second edit within 24 hours and an 11th edit within 30 days; rejected/paused templates accept unlimited edits
- Validation tests confirm: zero and negative values are rejected with inline errors; values exceeding the configured maximum are blocked; inputs beyond 4 decimal places are truncated correctly
- Template API call with bid_spec succeeds end-to-end on a Meta-enabled test WABA and returns the correct template ID

6.3 Per-Message Bid Multiplier

User Story U3: *As a business user, I want to adjust the template-level bid for a specific campaign send using a controlled slider, so I can respond dynamically to campaign urgency or audience value without editing the template.*

Behaviour

Input: A stepped slider/stepper control with the following constraints:

- Default value: 1.0×

- Minimum value: 1.0× (cannot go below the template bid)
- Maximum value: 3.0×
- Step precision: 0.1 increments only (e.g. 1.0, 1.1, 1.2 ... 3.0)

If not adjusted from default, effective bid = template bid_amount.

effective_bid = template_bid_amount × per_message_bid_multiplier

UI Display

- Control type: Slider with stepper arrows — not a free-text input field
- Show three-line summary beneath the control: Base bid (from template) / Multiplier (current slider value) / Effective bid (real-time calculated)
- Label: "Max-Price Multiplier" with tooltip: "Adjusts your template bid for this campaign. 1.0× applies the base bid with no change."
- Slider range visually labelled: "1.0× (Base)" on the left, "3.0× (Max)" on the right
- Mark as [Tentative] in UI until Meta confirms availability for the send-time multiplier

Acceptance Criteria

- AC1: Control renders as a slider/stepper — free-text entry is not permitted
- AC2: Default value is 1.0× on every new campaign send flow; does not persist from previous sends
- AC3: Minimum enforced at 1.0× — slider cannot go below the base bid
- AC4: Maximum enforced at 3.0× — slider cannot exceed this value
- AC5: Step size is exactly 0.1 — no intermediate values (e.g. 1.05, 1.23) are accepted or transmittable
- AC6: UI updates the effective bid display in real time as the slider moves
- AC7: When left at default (1.0×), the outbound /marketing_messages API call excludes per_message_bid_multiplier entirely — base bid applies implicitly
- AC8: When adjusted above 1.0×, bid_spec.per_message_bid_multiplier is transmitted with the exact slider value to the /marketing_messages endpoint
- AC9: Feature is gated — not exposed in production until Meta confirms availability

Validations

- V1: Values below 1.0 or above 3.0 are rejected both client-side and server-side
- V2: Values not conforming to 0.1 step increments are rejected server-side even if submitted via direct API call (bypassing UI)
- V3: Effective bid display must never show a value inconsistent with template_bid_amount × slider_value

Definition of Done

- Slider/stepper control renders correctly with default 1.0×, min 1.0×, max 3.0×, and 0.1 step — verified across supported browsers and devices

- Free-text entry into the multiplier field is not possible — confirmed via UI and API payload tests
- Default state (1.0×) confirmed to exclude per_message_bid_multiplier from the outbound API call — verified via payload inspection
- Slider values of 1.0×, 1.5×, 2.0×, 2.5×, and 3.0× tested end-to-end — all transmit correct bid_spec.per_message_bid_multiplier values and return successful delivery responses on an enabled test WABA
- Server-side rejection confirmed for any value outside [1.0, 3.0] or not conforming to 0.1 step precision, even when submitted directly via API
- Three-line summary (Base bid / Multiplier / Effective bid) updates in real time with no stale states
- [Tentative] label is visible in production UI until Meta formally confirms feature availability; DoD cannot be fully signed off until that confirmation is received

6.4 Reach Estimation

User Story U4: *As a business user, I want to preview estimated delivery rates and costs at my chosen bid — but only once my account has sufficient messaging history — so I can set an informed bid with confidence.*

Inputs

- Bid amount (carried from the template or multiplier input)
- Country (recipient phone number country, ISO code)
- Date interval dropdown: Last 1 day | Last 7 days | Last 14 days | Last 28 days (default: Last 7 days)

Trigger Condition

- Reach estimation values are only available after messaging events have been triggered for the WABA.
- If no messaging history exists for the selected country and date interval, the estimation panel must display a clear, non-blocking notice rather than empty or zero values.
- *Suggested notice: "Estimates will be available once your account has sent messages to this market. Send your first campaign to unlock reach data."*

Limitations

- Per template, maximum 100 API calls per day during editing.

API Call

GET /<WABA_ID>/reachestimate?targeting_spec={...}&date_interval=L7D

Output Display

Field	Calculation	Display Label
Estimated Delivery Rate	midpoint(lower_bound, upper_bound) / 1000	"~X% est. delivery"
Estimated Cost per Message	midpoint(cost_low, cost_high) / 1000	"Est. ~$X per message"

Acceptance Criteria

- AC1: Date interval is dropdown only — no free-text entry
- AC2: Default date interval = Last 7 days
- AC3: Display both estimated delivery rate and cost per message only when messaging history exists for the selected country and interval
- AC4: Show contextual label: "Based on last X days of historical data"
- AC5: If no messaging events exist for the selected country and interval, display the no-history notice — do not show zero values or blank fields
- AC6: Debounce bid input changes — trigger API call after 400 ms of inactivity
- AC7: Show loading indicator during API call. Estimation panel must not block template save or message send actions
- AC8: On API error (distinct from no-history state), display: "Estimates unavailable for this configuration" — do not block user action
- AC9: Include disclaimer on every result render: "Estimates are based on historical data and do not guarantee future performance."
- AC10: The no-history state and the API error state must render as visually distinct messages — users must be able to differentiate between "no data yet" and "something went wrong"

Non-Functional

- Perceived response time < 500 ms (show skeleton/loader beyond 300 ms).

Definition of Done

- Reach Estimation API is successfully called with correct targeting_spec (ISO country code) and date_interval parameters
- Date interval dropdown renders exactly four options (L1D, L7D, L14D, L28D) with L7D pre-selected — no free-text entry possible
- Estimated Delivery Rate and Cost per Message are calculated correctly using the midpoint formula — verified with known API responses
- No-history state is explicitly tested: For a WABA with zero messaging events, the estimation panel renders the no-history notice — not zero values, not blank fields, not a generic error
- No-history notice and API error state render as visually distinct messages — confirmed in QA
- Contextual label dynamically reflects the selected date interval

- Debounce confirmed at 400 ms — API not called on every keystroke, verified via network inspection
- Loading indicator appears within 300 ms; full response renders within 500 ms on a standard connection
- Estimation panel does not block or delay template save or message send under any condition — tested with artificially delayed API responses
- Disclaimer present on every result render including after interval or country changes
- Estimation widget tested in both template creation and campaign send flows

6.5 Template Category Restriction

User Story U5: *As the platform, I must restrict bidding to marketing templates only.*

- AC1: Bidding toggle and bid input are hidden for non-marketing template categories (UTILITY, AUTHENTICATION, SERVICE).
- AC2: Backend rejects any bid_spec submitted on a non-marketing template with a descriptive error.

Definition of Done

- Bidding toggle and all bid-related UI elements are confirmed hidden for UTILITY, AUTHENTICATION, and SERVICE template categories — verified across create and edit flows
- Backend rejects any bid_spec payload submitted against a non-marketing template with a descriptive, human-readable error response
- Client-side guard prevents bid_spec from being constructed or submitted for non-marketing templates — confirmed via frontend unit tests
- Test cases cover: attempting to add bid_spec via direct API call (bypassing UI) on a non-marketing template — server correctly rejects with a clear error
- No regression on marketing template bidding flow after category restriction logic is applied

6.6 API Routing & Endpoint Enforcement

User Story U6: *As a platform, I must route all bidding-enabled messages through the correct API endpoint to prevent error 131061.*

Endpoint	Usage
/marketing_messages	✅ Required for templates with bid_spec
/messages	❌ Not supported — returns error 131061

Error Handling

- Error 131061: "Marketing templates with bid_spec are not supported by the Cloud API." → Surface: "This template requires the Marketing Messages API. Please check your integration settings."
- Error 100: "Alpha testing legal agreement not signed." → Surface: "Please sign the beta agreement before sending."

Definition of Done

- All templates with bid_spec are confirmed to route exclusively through /marketing_messages — no instance of /messages being called for bid-enabled templates
- Error 131061 is intercepted and mapped to the user-facing message: "This template requires the Marketing Messages API. Please check your integration settings." — verified in QA
- Error 100 is intercepted and mapped to: "Please sign the beta agreement before sending." — verified in QA
- Integration tests cover the negative case: submitting a bid_spec template to /messages and confirming error 131061 is caught and surfaced correctly
- Routing logic is server-side and cannot be overridden by client configuration
- Endpoint enforcement tested across both template creation (Template API) and message sending (Message Sending API) flows

6.7 Default Behaviour (No Bid Set)

User Story U7: *As a business that has not opted in to dynamic pricing, I expect no change to my existing experience.*

- AC1: Templates without bid_spec → standard published rate applies. No UI change.
- AC2: Message sending flow unchanged for non-bidding templates.
- AC3: Pricing analytics, webhooks, and billing continue to reflect MARKETING_LITE regardless of bid_spec status.

Definition of Done

- Full regression suite for non-bidding template creation and message sending flows passes with zero failures
- Confirmed via API payload inspection that bid_spec is absent from all calls made by non-bidding WABAs or templates without a bid set
- Pricing Analytics confirmed to return MARKETING_LITE as pricing_category for messages sent without bid_spec
- Webhook payload confirmed to return marketing_lite as pricing.category for non-bidding sends
- Billing SKU confirmed as MARKETING_LITE — no change to invoicing for non-bidding accounts

- A/B test scenario validated: one template with bid_spec and one without, sent from the same WABA — both behave independently and correctly with no cross-contamination

6.8 Reporting — WhatsApp Template Report Updates

User Story U8: *As a business user, I want the WhatsApp template performance report to show me the billing type and actual cost per message for each template, so I can evaluate campaign spend accurately across standard and custom-priced sends.*

New Columns

Column	Values	Description
Billing Type	Standard / Custom	Reflects whether the template used the published rate card or had a bid_spec configured
Actual Cost per Message	Numeric (WABA currency)	Actual average cost per message delivered, sourced from Template Analytics cost_per_delivered

Column Logic

- Billing Type — Standard: template has no bid_spec; charged at the published rate.
- Billing Type — Custom: template has bid_spec configured; charged at max-price or lower.
- Actual Cost per Message: sourced from Template Analytics API cost_per_delivered value; displayed in WABA currency; averaged across all sends in the selected reporting period. If no deliveries occurred, display — (not zero).

Acceptance Criteria

- AC1: Both new columns appear in the WhatsApp template report for all users with reporting access.
- AC2: Billing Type renders as Standard for all templates without bid_spec and Custom for all templates with bid_spec — regardless of whether the bid was equal to, above, or below the published rate.
- AC3: Actual Cost per Message reflects the cost_per_delivered value from Template Analytics, averaged across the selected report period.
- AC4: Actual Cost per Message is displayed in the WABA's currency with consistent decimal formatting.
- AC5: When no deliveries occurred in the selected period, Actual Cost per Message displays — not $0.00.

- AC6: Both columns are sortable and filterable in the report interface.
- AC7: Existing report columns, filters, and exports are unaffected — zero regression on current reporting behaviour.
- AC8: CSV/Excel export includes both new columns with the same values as the UI.

Definition of Done

- Both new columns (Billing Type, Actual Cost per Message) are rendered in the WhatsApp template report across all supported report views
- Billing Type correctly shows Standard for non-bid templates and Custom for bid-enabled templates — verified against templates with and without bid_spec on the same WABA
- Actual Cost per Message is sourced correctly from cost_per_delivered in Template Analytics and displays the correct currency and decimal format
- No-delivery state renders — and not $0.00 — confirmed in QA with a template that has sends but zero deliveries in the selected period
- Sort and filter functions work correctly on both new columns
- CSV and Excel exports include the new columns with matching values to the UI — verified for both Standard and Custom billing type rows
- Full regression on existing report columns, filters, date range selectors, and exports — zero failures

6.9 Billing Module — Standard and Custom Pricing Logic

User Story U9: *As the platform, I need the billing module to correctly calculate and record charges for both standard rate card pricing and custom max-price bid pricing, so that invoices accurately reflect what each business is charged under each model.*

Billing Logic

Standard (no bid_spec):

```
charge = published_rate × messages_delivered
```

Behaviour unchanged from today. pricing_category = MARKETING_LITE.

Custom (bid_spec set):

```
charge = actual_cost_per_delivery × messages_deliveredwhere actual_cost_per_delivery ≤ bid_amount_per_message
```

Actual cost is determined by Meta's delivery system and will always be ≤ the bid_amount set on the template. The platform receives the actual cost via Template Analytics (cost_per_delivered) and Pricing Analytics (cost) — these are the source of truth for billing under the custom model. pricing_category = MARKETING_LITE (SKU does not change).

Acceptance Criteria

- AC1: Billing module identifies the pricing model per template send based on presence or absence of bid_spec.
- AC2: Standard pricing logic remains 100% unchanged — no regression on existing billing behaviour.
- AC3: For custom pricing, the charge applied per message is the cost_per_delivered value from Template Analytics — never exceeding the bid_amount set on the template.
- AC4: Billing records store the pricing model (Standard / Custom) per template sent for auditability.
- AC5: Invoice line items clearly distinguish Standard and Custom billed sends — either as separate line items or with a visible label.
- AC6: If cost_per_delivered is unavailable for a custom-priced send (e.g. API delay or error), the billing module must flag the record for manual review — it must not default to the published rate or bill zero.
- AC7: Billing calculations are consistent with the Actual Cost per Message displayed in the template report (U8) — no discrepancy between reporting and billing.
- AC8: All billing records are immutable once finalised — corrections require an explicit audit trail.

Validations

- V1: actual_cost_per_delivery must always be ≤ bid_amount_per_message — any record where this is violated must be flagged for finance review.
- V2: Zero-cost records on custom-priced sends must not be auto-processed — flag for review.
- V3: Billing module must handle mixed WABAs (some standard, some custom) on the same invoice without cross-contamination of pricing logic.

Definition of Done

- Billing module correctly identifies Standard vs Custom pricing per template send based on bid_spec presence — verified with unit tests covering both cases
- Standard billing logic passes full regression suite with zero failures — no change in behaviour for non-bid sends
- Custom billing correctly sources cost_per_delivered from Template Analytics and applies it as the charge — verified end-to-end on a test WABA with bid_spec configured
- Validated that actual_cost_per_delivery never exceeds bid_amount_per_message — edge case tests confirm flagging behaviour when this constraint is breached
- Billing records store pricing model (Standard / Custom) per send — confirmed in database schema and audit log
- Invoice output tested with mixed Standard and Custom sends on the same WABA — both appear correctly labelled with no cross-contamination

- Records with unavailable cost_per_delivered are flagged for manual review — not auto-billed and not defaulted to published rate
- Billing values reconcile with Actual Cost per Message in the template report (U8) — zero discrepancy confirmed across a sample of 10+ test sends
- Finance and Legal have signed off on the invoice format and audit trail requirements before this is marked fully done

7. UX Guidelines

7.1 Template Creation — Bid Configuration

- Place the bidding section below the template body, above the save/submit button.
- Default state: toggle OFF, section collapsed.
- On toggle ON: animate expand of bid input + estimation widget.
- Show recommended starting point: "Start at published rate, then experiment lower."
- Positive reinforcement: show estimated savings when effective bid < published rate.

7.2 Send / Campaign Flow — Multiplier

- Slider control. Label: "Max-Price Multiplier" with tooltip explaining the effect.
- Show three-line summary: Base bid / Multiplier / Effective bid.
- Mark as [Tentative] in UI until Meta confirms availability for the send-time multiplier.

7.3 Estimation Widget

- Show as an expandable panel ("Preview estimated reach") to avoid cluttering the main form.
- Use range bars or simple text; avoid complex visualisation during beta.
- Always accompany estimates with the disclaimer.
- If no messaging history exists, show the no-history notice instead of estimates — do not leave empty.

7.4 Bid Strategy Decision Guide

Surface an in-line decision guide to help businesses choose their starting bid:

Goal	Recommended bid	Expected outcome

Reduce costs, same reach	Same as published rate	~9% lower cost per delivery
Expand to new cohorts	10–30% below published rate	Wider reach at ~25% lower cost
Maximise delivery (peak campaigns)	10–25% above published rate	Higher delivery rate at premium cost

8. Technical Specifications

8.1 Template API — bid_spec

Create template with bid: POST /<WABA_ID>/message_templates

```
{ "name": "...", "category": "MARKETING", "language": "en", "components": [...], "bid_spec": { "bid_amount": 2000, "bid_strategy": "LOWEST_COST_WITH_BID_CAP" } }
```

Property	Type	Required	Description
bid_spec	object	optional	Container for bid configuration
bid_amount	int32	if bid_spec	Max bid per 1,000 deliveries, in currency's minimum denomination (e.g. cents for USD)
bid_strategy	enum	if bid_spec	Currently: LOWEST_COST_WITH_BID_CAP only

8.2 Message Sending API — Per-Message Multiplier

Send with multiplier: POST /<PHONE_NUMBER_ID>/marketing_messages

```
{ "recipient_type": "individual", "messaging_product": "whatsapp", "to": "...", "type": "template", "template": { ... }, "bid_spec": { "per_message_bid_multiplier": 1.5 } }
```

8.3 Reach Estimation API

Request: GET /<WABA_ID>/reachestimate?targeting_spec={"geo_locations":{"countries":["IN"]}}&date_interval=L7D

Field	Direction	Type	Description
targeting_spec	input	object	Contains geo_locations.countries (ISO array)

date_interval	input	enum	L1D | L7D | L14D | L28D
bid_amount	output	int	Bid per 1,000 deliveries for this estimation row
lower/upper_bound_deliveries	output	int	Estimated delivery range per 1,000 users
cost_lower/upper_bound	output	float	Estimated cost range per 1,000 deliveries

8.4 Observability — No Change

- Webhooks: pricing.category = marketing_lite regardless of bid_spec.
- Pricing Analytics: pricing_category = MARKETING_LITE.
- Template Analytics: product_type = MARKETING_MESSAGES_LITE_API.
- Billing SKU: MARKETING_LITE — no change.

9. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement	Rationale
Performance	Reach Estimation API response < 500 ms perceived (show loader at 300 ms)	Avoid slowing template creation UX
Data integrity	No mismatch between UI cost display and API bid_amount value	Prevent businesses setting unintended bids
Regression safety	Zero functional regression for non-bidding WABAs	Protect existing revenue and user trust
Consistency	Bidding logic identical across template creation, editing, and send flow	Prevent confusion from divergent states
Availability	Estimation API failure must be graceful — non-blocking	Business sends must not be gated on estimation availability
Security	Feature flag changes server-side; client cannot override gating	Prevent unenabled WABAs accessing feature

10. Dependencies

10.1 External Dependencies (Meta)

- WABA / Business ID enablement by Meta.
- Beta agreement signing process (details to be shared by Meta).
- Availability confirmation of per-message multiplier at send time (currently tentative).
- Reach Estimation API uptime and latency SLA.

10.2 Internal Dependencies

Team	Deliverable	Timeline dependency
Frontend	Bidding toggle, bid input, multiplier slider, estimation widget, real-time preview, report columns	Ready before Limited Beta (mid-May)
Backend	WABA flag store, bid_spec conversion, estimation API proxy, validation, error mapping, billing logic, report data sourcing	Ready before Limited Beta
DevOps	Feature flag infrastructure, API monitoring, performance alerting	Flag system before Alpha ends
Product / Ops	Meta coordination, WABA ID tracking, rollout comms	Ongoing
QA	Test plans: enabled vs disabled WABAs, edge cases, API failures, conversion accuracy, report accuracy, billing reconciliation	2 weeks before Limited Beta
Finance / Legal	Sign off on invoice format, audit trail, and bid cap values per currency	Before Open Beta

11. Open Questions & Risks

Question / Risk	Owner	Status
Per-message multiplier availability at send time — confirmed by Meta?	Product / Meta PM	⚠️ Tentative

Beta agreement process and signing mechanism	Ops / Meta	⚠️ Details pending
Maximum safe bid cap value per currency — who defines?	Product / Finance	🔲 Not defined
Webhook for aggregated cost per 1,000 deliveries (tentative by Meta)	Backend / Meta	⚠️ Tentative
Edit limit relaxation after GA — timeline and mechanism?	Meta	🔲 Future
Risk: businesses setting bids far above published rate — unexpectedly high bills	Product / Legal	🔴 Needs guard
At GA, does the feature auto-activate for all eligible WABAs or does manual enablement still apply?	Product / Legal	🔲 Open
What happens to WABAs in non-eligible geographies — are they permanently excluded?	Product / Legal	🔲 Open
What is the default bid behaviour for businesses that never set a max-price once it becomes the default mechanism?	Product / Legal	🔲 Open
U4: Should estimation widget be hidden or show no-history notice when WABA has zero messaging events? Confirm approach with design.	Product / Design	🔲 Open
U3: Minimum of 1.0× means businesses cannot adjust bid downward at campaign level. Is downward adjustment intended? Revisit if yes.	Product	🔲 Needs decision